

## **Project-Based Learning (PBL) FAQs**

### **1. What is PBL?**

PBL stands for Project-based Learning. It is a proven dynamic methodology where learning is done in a group through active exploration of organizational and real-world challenges and problems.

When participating in a PBL initiative, you earn knowledge and tools by working with a company or organization for a period, investing in and solving authentic and real problems or challenges.

For more info, please check the [PBL Learning Toolkit](#) for students.

### **2. Why should I choose PBL?**

PBL encourages students to work autonomously on high-impact projects while working with different stakeholders and people from diverse backgrounds and industries. It reinforces personal and professional skills and allows for the acquisition of deep content knowledge to cover academic objectives, project needs, and self-ambitious goals.

### **3. What kind of PBL initiatives does Nova SBE offer?**

Nova SBE offers several PBL initiatives that you can do during your master's program. You will find short and intensive PBLs, courses all based on PBL, Work Projects and even masters with an immersive PBL.

For more info, please check the [PBL Learning Toolkit](#) for students.

### **4. Do all PBL initiatives have ECTS?**

Yes, they do. The number of ECTS depends on the duration and type of PBL.

For more info, please check the PBL Learning Toolkit for students.

### **5. Can I do a PBL within my master thesis?**

Yes, it's a very good option for your master's thesis! We have several PBL projects to offer you within the master thesis. They are all supported by a corporate partner.

Please check the Student App to find our offer during the application period (you will receive information from the Work Project Team)

### **6. How does PBL differ from the other Work Project formats?**

PBL is always about responding to a real challenge or question of a company/ organization within a group of 3 to 5 students. With PBL each student has a voice and a choice and is expected to work with independence and autonomy while always being supported by appropriate and relevant data and theories.

In the end, you (and your team) will develop in-depth knowledge and the 21st Century competencies to create a concrete and authentic impact (e.g., Managerial, public policy, social).

During the PBL process, you will have a supportive organization partner and a key decision-maker to provide support and implement the solution(s) as well as the orientation of an academic advisor.

PBL is assessed by Faculty, yourself, and your peers.

For more info, please check the PBL Learning Toolkit for students.

#### **7. What types of PBLs can I find on the Student App?**

We have several initiatives that are work project related:

- Consulting Labs
- Impact Labs
- Marketing Labs
- PBL Work Projects
- International Consulting Labs
- Business Projects

To apply, please check the Student App when indicated by the Nova SBE Work Project Team and follow their guidelines.

For more info, please check the PBL Learning Toolkit for students.

#### **8. Who is involved in a PBL??**

- Students – your team, usually of 3-5 students
- Advisors – faculty that will advise your work.
- Corporate partners – Nova SBE partners that provide the challenges and welcome you to their projects.
- Mentors (optional)- Alumni experts willing to help you with industry and expert insights.

For more info, please check the PBL Learning Toolkit for students.

#### **9. Is PBL complex?**

PBL represents a smooth transition to real life in a safe environment. And like in real life, you may face different limitations and challenges related to time, tools, relationships, competencies, etc. But you will learn throughout the process and receive advice and support from high-level professionals from academia and industry.

For more info, please check the PBL Learning Toolkit for students.

#### **10. Can I have a full-time job during my PBL?**

We highly recommend full commitment to your work Project and especially if it's with a PBL Lab. You will need to be involved with your team, the team from the organization, and you will have to finish your work in a short period of time. Time management is crucial with PBL!